



SUDHEER SALUNKE

PROFILE

PMP-certified Project Manager with 12+ years of global experience in industrialization projects. Holding an Executive MBA and a Master's in Mechanical Engineering, I excel in leading cross-functional teams, driving process optimization, and implementing best practices to enhance efficiency and reduce costs. Skilled in project strategy, budgeting, risk management, and KPI tracking, I consistently deliver high-quality results on time while aligning projects with strategic business goals.

EXPERIENCE

Project Manager- Development Projects, 06/2023 - 12/2024 ZF Friedrichshafen AG - Schweinfurt, Germany

- Led clutch and actuation system programs from pre-acquisition to SOP, ensuring on-time delivery through structured gate reviews defined in the ZF GDPEP process, complemented by selective use of Agile practices.
- Managed end-to-end industrialization activities, including CapEx planning, tooling development, production-line setup, and the commissioning of special-purpose machines, robots/cobots, and material-handling equipment.
- Directed global cross-functional teams mechanical, electronics, software, sourcing, operations, quality, finance, logistics, and sales, to achieve program milestones and secure a seamless transition into series production.
- Collaborated with engineering, procurement, operations, and logistics to ensure the timely availability of materials, tooling, and spare parts, enabling PPAP readiness and a smooth production ramp-up.
- Conducted cost-driver analysis and evaluated inflation impacts to support procurement negotiations, strengthen supplier performance, and deliver measurable cost savings.
- Applied Lean and Six Sigma methodologies, including value stream mapping to standardize processes, eliminate waste, and drive continuous improvement across development and production workflows.
- Monitored key KPIs to align the program's business case with cost, quality, timing, and profitability targets, implementing optimization measures to safeguard project margins.
- Improved transparency and stakeholder alignment through standardized reporting using JIRA, MS Project, Think-Cell, MindManager, and SAP, enabling clear communication and informed decision-making.

Project Engineering Manager, 07/2018 - 05/2023 ZF Friedrichshafen AG - Dielingen, Germany

- Led advanced chassis system and component projects from concept to production, ensuring on-time delivery and meeting OEM quality expectations.
- Managed end-to-end engineering activities by coordinating cross-functional teams across design, core engineering, procurement, testing, suppliers, and customer engineering.
- Collaborated with purchasing for supplier selection, resolved technical issues, and supported commercial negotiations.

PERSONAL DETAILS

- 📍 97421, Schweinfurt
- ☎ +49-15560989101
- ✉ sudheersalunke@gmail.com

SKILLS

- Leadership
- Team Management
- Strategic Planning & Execution
- Cost Management
- Engineering Innovation
- Project Management
- Communication
- Interpersonal Skills
- Problem-Solving
- Adaptability
- Decision-Making

EDUCATION

Executive MBA,
Mannheim Business School -
Mannheim, Germany
04/2021 - 09/2022

Master's in Mechanical
Engineering,
Savitribai Phule Pune University
- Pune, India 05/2015 - 05/2018

Bachelor's in Industrial
Engineering,
IIIE - Navi Mumbai, India
03/2009 - 01/2015

LANGUAGES

English (Fluent): C2
Proficient

German (Good): B2
Upper intermediate

Hindi (Native): C2

Proficient

Kannada (Native): C2



Proficient

Marathi (Native): C2



Proficient

HOBBIES

- Floorball
- Chess
- Marathon running
- Exploring AI Applications

WORK AUTHORIZATION & MOBILITY

- EU Work Authorized
- Open to Relocation
- Flexible for Onsite or Hybrid Roles

- Prepared SORs, SOWs, technical documentation, and R&D cost estimates; developed RFQs and detailed component drawings for cast, forged, and machined parts, including material specifications, GD&T, coatings, and marking requirements.
- Standardized global engineering practices by creating and releasing chassis component templates, improving efficiency and reducing development costs.
- Conducted brainstorming sessions, benchmarking, and patent reviews to drive innovation and identify system and component improvement opportunities.
- Led development of SPDO (Simulation Product Design Optimization) software using Agile methodology—managed requirements, tracked progress, and achieved reduction in FEA hours and project costs.
- Delivered global training and workshops during software rollout, strengthening engineering capability and ensuring global adoption.
- Applied ZF's GDPEP framework for structured development, including gate reviews and industry-standard validation processes (DV/PV). Used CATIA for 3D modeling, GD&T, drawing reviews, and packaging design to optimized layouts.

Manager Design and Development, 03/2013 - 06/2018

ZF India Pvt. Ltd. - Pune, India

- Led a 5-member cross-functional engineering team on system-level chassis design and development projects, ensuring on-time delivery, global coordination, and engagement with Indian OEM customers.
- Standardized design methods and templates for components such as knuckles and control arms, reducing design cycles and achieving cost savings across programs.
- Collaborated with sourcing teams to evaluate supplier quotes, negotiate costs, and support cost control within program KPIs.
- Mentored and trained team members on quality tools (GD&T, DFMEA, 8D) and supplier monitoring techniques to enhance team efficiency and process maturity.
- Worked on-site in the USA and led the offshore engineering team in India, ensuring alignment with project requirements, design consistency, and on-time program delivery.

Design Engineer, 08/2011 - 02/2013

Tata Motors Ltd. - Pune, India

- Led Value Analysis/Value Engineering (VA/VE) initiatives for chassis systems, reviewing component design, material usage, and manufacturing processes to identify practical cost-saving opportunities without compromising performance or safety.
- Conducted competitive benchmarking on newly launched vehicles by analyzing teardown reports, evaluating parts, and comparing materials, features, and production processes. Proposed feasible design and process changes for ongoing programs, achieving measurable cost reductions. (worked here, Pay roll-on Tata Technologies Ltd.)

Project Engineer/Sr. Engineer, 07/2007 - 08/2011

Dana India Tech. Center Pvt. Ltd. & L&T IES - India

- Managed engineering changes for front and rear off-highway axles, including axle and differential housings, transitioning from gray cast iron to ductile iron to improve strength, reduce weight, and lower overall assembly cost.
- Supported procurement and customer approvals, ensuring supplier readiness and cost-effective implementation of material changes.
- Delivered hourly-rate design engineering services, focusing on system and subsystem integration, sheet metal, casting, and forging components, while identifying opportunities to reduce manufacturing costs without compromising performance or safety.

CAD-CAM Engineer-Manufacturing, 10/2002 - 07/2007

K.C. Toolroom Pvt. Ltd. & Tara Tools - Pune, India

- Supervised workshop operations and served as the technical liaison with customers, presenting tooling concepts in design reviews. Led CNC machining for dies and molds, ensuring precision, on-time delivery, and quality compliance.
- Performed bottom-up cost calculations for dies, molds, and fixtures, evaluating complexity, materials, machining, labor, supplier capability, and cycle times.
- Programmed FANUC 6-axis robots for welding and gas cutting, improving automation and reducing cycle times.
- Conducted Gemba walks to gather operator feedback and implement improvements in fixture design, ergonomics, and manufacturability.
- Applied Kaizen and Lean principles to minimize setup times, reduce waste, and enhance workflow efficiency.

TRAINING AND CERTIFICATIONS

- **Project Management Professional (PMP)**, Project Management Institute (PMI), 4135909, 07/01/25, 07/01/28
- PMI-ACP – Agile Certified Practitioner, in progress
- Outdoor Leadership and Management, SCYFCO, France
- GD&T, CATIA, AutoCAD, Creo CAD Software, IATF 16949
- PLM/PDM: Teamcenter, Pro-Intralink, and Enovia
- 6-Axis Industrial Robot Training, FANUC India
- German B1-Goethe certificate, **B2 Level in progress**



Sudheer Salunke, Schweinfurt den 10.12.2025